

destroyed, though such blasphemy would surely raise the ire of Heaven.

- ⑤ **Magnitude** allows the Hsien to influence successively-larger parts of the world — without it, the most that can be targeted is something roughly human-sized. The first die allocated expands the limit to larger objects — trees, boulders, vehicles, and the like. The second influences entire paths, streets, streams, or buildings. Further dice expand the area of control, first to entire woods, rivers, or fields, then to entire mountains, and finally to entire chains of mountains, great forests, and at last to the very limit of the horizon itself. Magnitude should not be confused with Domain, which governs the distance between the Hsien and the center of her alchemical miracle — Magnitude is for the overall size of the miracle itself, its “footprint” as opposed to its “stride.”

## Elemental Cohorts

Each elemental Alchemy is complete unto itself, but, like the elements they represent, they too are part of a greater cycle. Because of this, it is possible to combine Alchemies together to create a unified effect — for example, transforming water into metal, extracting metal from stone without the benefit of a forge, or to create scorching lava from nothing at all. This is easiest when the elements feed naturally from one into another — wood into fire, fire into earth, and so on. Opposing that cycle, going from earth to water, metal to fire, and so forth is much more difficult. Using multiple Alchemies in a single effect is referred to as a cohort, and costs one Yugen per Alchemy in addition to whatever is needed to generate the effect. If the cohort consists of elements that create a constructive cycle

(for example, wood-fire, or fire-earth-metal), the Yugen cost is one lower—if that cycle is opposed, the difficulty of the Wu Tan roll is raised by one. Using all five Alchemies together is a constructive cohort, of course, though a very expensive one. The Storyteller is the ultimate arbiter of what elements are being called upon in any given effect.

## Countermagic

All things must end, and so too must magic, even the magic of the Shinma. Sometimes, in fact, that magic needs to end sooner than planned, especially in these chaotic times where Hsien may even oppose Hsien. Countermagic, therefore, is Wu Tan applied to oppose Wu Tan, and two means of doing so exist.

When contesting an effect in the process of being created, the rival's Chi must be balanced out to negate the effect. To accomplish this, the opposing Chi must be used. By spending one Yugen, the Hsien may roll a dice pool equal to the Chi being used to balance the effect, with successes cancelling out successes on the Wu Tan roll on a one-for-one basis. A Hsien can only attempt to oppose a single effect once. More than one Hsien may aid in this task, with many smaller Shinma overwhelming a single Hsien, though care should be taken, for if the effect is overbalanced, resulting in net successes for those employing countermagic, the effect can easily go awry in a way not even the caster intended.

When attempting to destroy a persistent effect, however, Yin Chi is preferred, as it represents decay and dissolution. By using adversarial Alchemies, the effect will be destabilized and collapse. However, as the effect has already been created and wound into the tapestry of creation, it must be unwoven bit

## Adversarial Elements

